

just set up the required number of email accounts from your control panel. Setting up email from Google apps has the advantage of more inbox space, better uptimes and the ability to configure, train and handover – that's configure the domain, train one of your client's employees about how to set up new email accounts, and then handover total control to the client. You can do the same if you have a reseller account as well, but we just love the extra features that Google throws in...

2.3.4 Web design

If your clients want a web site, there's a good chance they will also look to you to get it designed – if you have the skills and pitch for it. Thanks to so many open source CMSes, HTML templates and what you see is what you get (WYSIWYG) editors, it's not even hard to set up a basic site anymore. All you need is some spare time, and you could have a basic site up and running in a matter of hours. Sometimes this process is so fast that between the time the domain is bought, and the time it takes for DNS servers to start pointing the domain to the hosting solution, people already have basic sites up and running.

Web design does eat into a lot of your time. So although it's a good service to offer when you're starting up, because it makes your services seem more like end-to-end solutions, in the long run you may want to stick to the things you're good at. Of course, this could also mean that if you're good at web design, you may want to start focussing on that – you might also find some more business improving the design of existing sites.

Of course as your business moves along, you will start realising the input to output ratio of efforts is to returns. For example, if you find yourself making a lot of profits selling domain names, it would be silly to waste a lot of your time trying to bag design contracts, when that same time could be spent finding more domain buyers.

2.3.5 Custom solutions

This one's a bit tricky, because small businesses have very varied needs when you dig deeper than the four mentioned above. One example that springs to mind would be a business that's looking to increase its chances of being found online.

You could get all technical by trying to explain the complexities of search engine optimization (SEO) to your client, and then arrive at a price if that's something you think you can handle. However, the domain-host-mail-SEO solution is not what every company out there is looking for. For example, some clients might ask you to help them indulge in some social media marketing (SMM). This could be setting up a Facebook page for